

DAY 7

Scrum Framework: Roles, Events & Artifacts

Learning Objectives:

- Understand the Scrum framework in full: roles, events, and artifacts
- Learn the difference between Scrum roles: Product Owner, Scrum Master, Development Team
- Understand all Scrum events: Sprint, Sprint Planning, Daily Standup, Sprint Review, Retrospective
- Understand Scrum artifacts: Product Backlog, Sprint Backlog, Increment, Definition of Done
- **YouTube Search Terms:**
 - "Scrum framework explained in 10 minutes"
 - "Scrum roles responsibilities"
 - "Scrum events explained"
 - "Product backlog vs sprint backlog"
- **Recommended Channels:**
 - Atlassian
 - Agile Alliance
 - Google Project Management Certificate

Tasks:

- Study each Scrum role in depth and write a clear one-paragraph explanation of what each role owns, what they are responsible for, and what they must never do — PMs often fill the Scrum Master role, so understand this role deeply
- Study the Sprint as the core container of Scrum — what a Sprint is, why it is time-boxed, what happens if a Sprint must be cancelled, and how Sprint length is decided
- Write a Scrum roles and responsibilities document for the Expense Tracker project — define who the Product Owner is, who the Scrum Master is, and what the development team size and skills are
- Write a one-page summary of all 5 Scrum events — what happens in each, who attends, how long it lasts for a 2-week sprint, and what the output is

Deliverable

- Scrum roles and responsibilities document
- Scrum events summary — 5 events explained with purpose, attendees, duration, and output
- Short note: how a PM in a Scrum team is different from a traditional PM

1. Scrum Roles

Product Owner (PO)

The Product Owner is responsible for maximizing the value of the product and ensuring the team builds the right features. They own and manage the Product Backlog, prioritize requirements, define acceptance criteria, and communicate business needs to the team. The Product Owner represents customers and stakeholders and makes final decisions on feature priorities. They must never micromanage developers, assign technical tasks, or interfere with how the team performs its work. Their focus is on *what* should be built and *why* it matters.

Scrum Master (SM)

The Scrum Master is the facilitator and coach of the Scrum team. Their responsibility is to ensure Scrum practices are followed correctly, remove obstacles that slow down the team, facilitate Scrum events, and help the team continuously improve. They protect the team from distractions and help stakeholders understand Scrum principles. A Scrum Master must never act as a traditional manager, assign work to team members, or make product decisions. Their focus is on improving the process and enabling the team to work effectively.

Development Team

The Development Team consists of professionals who build, test, and deliver the product increment during each Sprint. Team members may include frontend developers, backend developers, QA engineers, UI/UX designers, database specialists, and DevOps engineers. The team is self-managing and decides how work is completed. They are responsible for meeting Sprint Goals and delivering a potentially shippable product increment. They must never wait for task assignments from managers or shift responsibility for delivery to others.

2. Sprint - The Core Container of Scrum

A Sprint is a fixed-length period during which the Scrum Team works to achieve a specific goal and deliver a usable product increment. Most teams use Sprint lengths between one and four weeks, with two weeks being very common. The Sprint provides a predictable rhythm for planning, development, review, and improvement.

Why is a Sprint Time-Boxed?

- Creates predictable delivery cycles
- Encourages focus on a defined goal
- Reduces scope creep
- Enables regular stakeholder feedback

- Helps measure team velocity and progress

How is Sprint Length Decided?

The team selects a Sprint length based on:

- Product complexity
- Frequency of feedback needed
- Team maturity
- Release requirements

Once chosen, Sprint length usually remains consistent.

Can a Sprint Be Cancelled?

Yes, but only the Product Owner can cancel a Sprint. This happens rarely when:

- Business priorities change drastically
- Market conditions change
- The Sprint Goal becomes irrelevant

When cancelled:

- Completed work is reviewed
- Remaining work returns to the Product Backlog
- A new Sprint Planning session is conducted

3. Scrum Roles & Responsibilities for Expense Tracker Project

Product Owner

Role: Project Manager / Business Representative

Responsibilities

- Define product vision and roadmap
- Prioritize Product Backlog
- Gather stakeholder feedback
- Approve completed features
- Define acceptance criteria

Key Decisions

- Which features are built first
 - Release priorities
 - Scope changes
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Scrum Master

Role: Agile Project Manager

Responsibilities

- Facilitate Scrum events
- Remove team blockers
- Track Sprint progress
- Ensure Scrum practices are followed
- Improve team collaboration

Key Decisions

- Process improvements
 - Team coaching activities
 - Sprint facilitation methods
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Development Team

Team Size: 5 Members

Role	Responsibility
Frontend Developer	User interface development
Backend Developer	APIs and business logic
Database Developer	Database design and optimization
QA Engineer	Testing and quality assurance
UI/UX Designer	User experience and visual design

Team Skills

- React / HTML / CSS
 - Node.js / Java / .NET
 - SQL Database Management
 - Testing & Automation
 - UI/UX Design
 - Git & GitHub
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4. Scrum Events Summary (2-Week Sprint)

Scrum Event	Purpose	Attendees	Duration (2-Week Sprint)	Output
Sprint	Container for all Scrum work	Entire Scrum Team	2 Weeks	Working Product Increment
Sprint Planning	Decide Sprint Goal and work items	PO, SM, Dev Team	Up to 4 Hours	Sprint Goal & Sprint Backlog
Daily Scrum (Standup)	Synchronize progress and identify blockers	Development Team (SM optional)	15 Minutes Daily	Updated plan for next 24 hours
Sprint Review	Demonstrate completed work and gather feedback	Scrum Team + Stakeholders	Up to 2 Hours	Product Backlog updates
Sprint Retrospective	Improve team process and collaboration	Scrum Team	Up to 1.5 Hours	Action items for improvement

Detailed Explanation of the 5 Events

1. Sprint

The Sprint is the main working cycle in Scrum. All development activities occur within the Sprint. The team focuses on achieving a Sprint Goal and delivering a potentially releasable product increment.

SCRUM HAS FIVE FORMAL EVENTS



2. Sprint Planning

The team decides:

- What work will be completed
- Why it is important
- How it will be done

The Product Owner presents priorities, and the team commits to achievable work.

3. Daily Scrum

A short daily meeting where developers discuss:

- What was completed yesterday
- What will be worked on today
- Any blockers preventing progress

This meeting improves transparency and coordination.

4. Sprint Review

At the end of the Sprint, the team demonstrates completed functionality to stakeholders. Feedback is collected and used to update future priorities.

5. Sprint Retrospective

The team reflects on:

- What went well
- What did not go well
- What can be improved

The goal is continuous improvement in teamwork and delivery.

5. Scrum Artifacts

Product Backlog

An ordered list of all desired product features, enhancements, bug fixes, and requirements. Owned by the Product Owner.

Sprint Backlog

The set of Product Backlog items selected for the current Sprint along with the plan to deliver them.

Increment

The completed work produced during a Sprint that meets the Definition of Done and adds value to the product.

Definition of Done (DoD)

A shared checklist that determines when work is truly complete.

Example DoD:

- Code written
- Code reviewed
- Testing passed
- Bugs fixed
- Documentation updated
- Product Owner accepts feature

6. Scrum PM vs Traditional PM

Traditional Project Manager	PM in Scrum Environment
Directly manages team members	Facilitates and supports team
Assigns tasks	Team self-manages work
Controls schedule and execution	Focuses on priorities and value
Makes most project decisions	Decisions are shared across Scrum roles
Tracks project completion	Enables Agile delivery and stakeholder alignment
Success measured by scope, time, cost	Success measured by customer value and adaptability

In a Scrum environment, a PM often works closely with the Product Owner or Scrum Master role. Instead of controlling people and tasks, the PM focuses on product value, stakeholder communication, removing risks, and helping the team deliver customer-focused outcomes.